İlkşen Çetintaş

CHIEF HUMAN RESOURCES OFFICER · EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE MEMBER

Organizational transformation · Reward & job architecture · Board partner on workforce cost, productivity and people risk

Ankara, Türkiye · linkedin.com/in/ilkşen-çetintaş-b52a6920 · Dual Turkish & EU citizen · open to international relocation

~5,000 employees in Group HR remit at IC Holding	**4% → 25%** women in technical roles in 1 year · EBRD Gold
2026 IPO CHRO of ŞA-RA through its Borsa İstanbul listing	**3×** HR functions built: Siemens, TED University, ŞA-RA

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

CHRO and Executive Committee member who turns founder-led industrial groups into institutions. At **ŞA-RA Group** (~2,000 employees, 11 factories; listed on Borsa İstanbul in 2026) built HR governance, group-wide grading and pay, and a productivity unit that links labor cost to production tonnage for Board capacity decisions. Previously Deputy GM HR of **IC Holding** (~5,000 employees), leading the gender initiative behind an EBRD Gold Award, then CHRO of defense company **Nurol Teknoloji**. Trained at **Siemens** and **Turkish Aerospace (TAI)**. Targeting CHRO, Chief People Officer and Group HR Director roles in Türkiye and internationally.

SIGNATURE ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Award-winning gender inclusion:** led the initiative that raised women in technical roles from 4% to 25% within one year at TREDAŞ, IC Holding's electricity distributor; the program won the EBRD Gold Award for Environmental & Social Best Practice (2019).
- **Institutionalized a ~2,000-employee, 11-factory group** as CHRO through its July 2026 Borsa İstanbul listing: built ŞA-RA's HR operating model, governance, grading and pay structure and people systems from the ground up.
- **Productivity managed like a P&L line:** founded a Workforce Productivity & Planning Unit that ties planned vs. actual production tonnage to unit labor cost and workforce mix, giving the Board a fact base for capacity and headcount decisions.
- **One pay logic for ~5,000 employees:** Hay-based job evaluation across every IC Holding company, with a common grading framework and salary scales, so pay decisions became consistent and defensible across construction, energy, airports and tourism.
- **HR as a business at Siemens Communications Türkiye:** built the HR function, played a key role in turning it into a profit center through internal service agreements and pricing, and led the Siemens Leadership Excellence program that became a benchmark across Siemens Europe.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ŞA-RA Group (ŞA-RA Enerji İnşaat Tic. ve San. A.Ş.) · Ankara — 2021 – Present

Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) · Executive Committee Member

Energy-infrastructure manufacturer and contractor founded in 1985: steel structures, transmission hardware and galvanizing; 11 factories, projects in 120+ countries; ~2,000 employees. Listed on Borsa İstanbul in July 2026.

- **Transformation:** lead the group's institutionalization and culture change, building HR policies, organization structures and people systems (workforce planning, recruitment, succession, careers, leadership development) from the ground up and moving HR from an operational approval role to a strategic function accountable for governance, workforce productivity and organizational effectiveness.
- **Board partnership:** strategic partner to the Board and Executive Committee, preparing the productivity, workforce-cost and people-risk analyses behind workforce and capacity decisions.
- **Workforce productivity:** founded and lead the Workforce Productivity & Planning Unit; designed a planning framework linking planned vs. actual production tonnage, unit labor cost and workforce composition across heavy industrial operations.

- **Reward architecture:** built a grade- and band-based salary structure (minimum, midpoint, maximum per grade) across all Group companies, positioned every role against it and proposed salary adjustments to improve internal pay equity (compensation & benefits).
- **Pay for performance:** designed scorecard-based management by objectives (departmental goal pools, shared cross-functional goals, weighted individual scorecards with evidence requirements) and a variable-pay framework combining scorecard, competency and talent-matrix results, so bonuses follow measurable outcomes.
- **HR digitalization:** designed and implemented an e-HR platform inside the company ERP, putting objectives, competency assessments and approval workflows on one system.
- **Governance & cost:** brought labor-law compliance and people risk under one HR governance framework; prepare the annual HR budget (salaries, bonuses, statutory contributions, severance, benefits, training, consultancy).

Nurol Teknoloji A.Ş. · Ankara 2019 – 2021

Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO)

Defense-technology company of Nurol Holding: advanced ballistic ceramics and armor systems for personnel, vehicles and aircraft; exports worldwide.

- **Succession for critical roles:** led HR strategy for a defense exporter and built performance, talent-development and reward systems that strengthened the leadership pipeline and succession readiness for critical technical roles; introduced competency-based learning frameworks to improve role readiness.
- **Regulated operations:** managed large blue-collar workforces and regulatory compliance in a highly controlled defense environment.
- **Early-career & diversity:** launched diversity-focused internships and university–industry programs, expanding the early-career talent pipeline and improving workforce diversity indicators.
- **HR technology:** played a direct role in SAP integration and the implementation of SAP SuccessFactors.

IC Holding (IC İbrahim Çeçen Yatırım Holding) · Ankara 2013 – 2019

Deputy General Manager, Human Resources

Diversified Turkish conglomerate: construction & infrastructure (incl. the Yavuz Sultan Selim Bridge and Northern Marmara Motorway), energy generation and distribution (TREDAŞ), airports, tourism and industry; ~5,000 employees in HR remit.

- **Gender inclusion:** led the TREDAŞ initiative that lifted women in technical roles from 4% to 25% in one year (EBRD Gold Award 2019).
- **Job architecture:** ran Hay-based job evaluation across all holding companies (know-how, problem solving, decision authority, management scope and financial impact) and set job grades and salary scales on one common framework, enabling consistent pay decisions and internal equity Group-wide.
- **Workforce cost:** directed HR strategy and workforce-cost planning; prepared HR budgets for salaries, variable pay, statutory contributions, termination costs, benefits, training and consultancy.
- **Pay for performance:** designed corporate competency management and variable-compensation scorecards linking performance outcomes directly to reward.
- **HR digitalization:** led SAP-based HR process implementation and workforce analytics, improving data transparency and management decision-making.

TED University · Ankara 2011 – 2013

HR Director

Foundation university established by the Turkish Education Association (TED); joined during its establishment, ahead of the 2012 academic launch.

- Built the university's HR function and people-governance framework from inception, as part of the establishment team.

Swissôtel Ankara · Ankara 2009 – 2011

HR Director · Executive Committee Member

Five-star luxury hotel of the Swissôtel Hotels & Resorts brand.

- Led talent development and change initiatives within global hospitality operations as a member of the hotel's Executive Committee.

Siemens Communications, Türkiye

1996 – 2006

Group Human Resources Manager

Siemens Industries Inc.: Siemens' telecommunications business in Türkiye, covering carrier infrastructure, enterprise networks and mobile devices.

- **HR as a business:** established and led the HR department; played a key role in transforming it from a service unit into a profit center through internal service agreements and pricing, strengthening cost transparency and accountability.
- **Leadership:** led the Siemens Leadership Excellence program in Türkiye, which became a benchmark across Siemens Europe.
- **Reward:** led company-wide job evaluation (CRG, Hay), built grade- and band-based pay structures and tied corporate scorecards to variable pay.
- **Talent systems:** set up assessment and development centers, onboarding and outplacement programs; coordinated the rollout of the global recruitment portal across Turkish operations; contributed directly to SAP HR integration.

Turkish Aerospace Industries (TAI) · Ankara

1988 – 1996

Senior HR Lead

Türkiye's national aerospace company, founded in 1984 for F-16 co-production.

- Contributed to HR policy for job evaluation, salary scales, wage policy, salary surveys, performance management and reward; delivered appraisal and development workshops (HR management, business ethics) for first-line and middle managers.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

2025 **Exemplary Woman HR Marvel of the Year**, Global Business Conclave, London (White Page International).

2024 **Global 200 Power Leaders in HR**, selected among senior executives from 42 countries, Dubai (White Page International).

2019 **EBRD Gold Award, Environmental & Social Best Practice**, won by TREDAŞ / IC İçtaş Elektrik for its gender-inclusion program; led the initiative and was instrumental in securing the award.

2018 **Ministry of Energy and Natural Resources Award**: selected among the top three most successful businesswomen in mining and energy.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- People & HR Strategy
- Business & Culture Transformation
- HR Governance & People Risk
- Job Evaluation (Hay, CRG)
- Performance & Variable Pay
- Succession & Career Planning
- Culture & Employee Engagement
- HR Digital Transformation & HRIS
- Employment Law Compliance
- HR Operating Model Design
- Change Management
- Compensation & Benefits
- Grading & Salary Structures
- Strategic Workforce Planning
- Talent Management
- Diversity, Equity & Inclusion
- SAP & SAP SuccessFactors
- Multi-site & Blue-collar Workforces
- Organizational Effectiveness
- Board & Stakeholder Management
- Reward Strategy & Total Rewards
- Internal Pay Equity
- Workforce Cost & Productivity
- Leadership Development
- Talent Acquisition & Early Careers
- People Analytics
- Assessment & Development Centers

EDUCATION

Middle East Technical University (METU), Bachelor's Degree in Management — Ankara

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages	Turkish (native) · English (advanced) · German (good working proficiency)
Mobility	Dual Turkish & EU citizen; open to relocation within Türkiye and internationally

REFERENCES

Senior references (TED, Siemens) available on request.